

NCEA Level 2 Literacy Knowledge Base

Overview

The NCEA Literacy co-requisite ensures students have foundational reading and writing skills. From 2024, students must achieve 10 literacy credits (plus 10 numeracy credits) as a 20-credit co-requisite for any NCEA qualification.

Literacy Standards

US32403: Demonstrate Understanding of Ideas and Information in Written Texts (Literacy Reading)

Credits: 5

Level: 1

Assessment: External Common Assessment Activity (CAA)

Skills Required:

- Make sense of written texts
- Read with critical awareness
- Read for different purposes
- Identify main ideas and supporting details
- Understand vocabulary in context
- Recognise text structures and features
- Evaluate information for reliability and bias
- Make inferences from text

Assessment Criteria:

- **Achieved:** Demonstrates understanding of ideas and information in written texts
- Graded as “Achieved” or “Not Achieved” only

Common Text Types:

- Articles and reports
 - Persuasive texts
 - Informational texts
 - Narratives
 - Instructions and procedures
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US32405: Write Texts to Communicate Ideas and Information (Literacy Writing)

Credits: 5

Level: 1

Assessment: External Common Assessment Activity (CAA)

Skills Required:

- Write meaningful texts for different purposes
- Write for different audiences
- Use written language conventions effectively
- Structure writing appropriately
- Use paragraphing correctly
- Apply grammar and punctuation rules
- Choose vocabulary appropriate to purpose
- Edit and proofread writing

Assessment Criteria:

- **Achieved:** Writes texts to communicate ideas and information
- Graded as “Achieved” or “Not Achieved” only

Common Writing Types:

- Explanations
 - Persuasive writing
 - Reports
 - Formal letters/emails
 - Narratives
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Key Literacy Concepts

Reading Skills Framework

Literal Understanding:

- Identify explicitly stated information
- Locate specific details
- Understand vocabulary in context

Inferential Understanding:

- Read between the lines
- Make logical deductions
- Understand implied meaning

Critical Analysis:

- Evaluate author’s purpose
- Identify bias and perspective
- Assess reliability of information
- Compare different viewpoints

Writing Skills Framework

PEEL Paragraph Structure:

- **Point:** State your main idea
- **Evidence:** Provide supporting details
- **Explanation:** Explain how the evidence supports your point
- **Link:** Connect to the next paragraph or overall argument

SEXI Structure (Alternative):

- **S**tatement: Make your point
- **E**xplanation: Elaborate on it
- **X** (eXample): Provide evidence
- **I**mportance: Explain why it matters

Language Conventions**Grammar:**

- Subject-verb agreement
- Correct tense usage
- Pronoun-antecedent agreement
- Sentence structure variety

Punctuation:

- Full stops, commas, question marks
- Apostrophes for possession and contractions
- Quotation marks
- Colons and semicolons

Spelling:

- Common words spelled correctly
 - Homophones distinguished correctly
 - Consistent spelling throughout
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Assessment Tips

For Reading (US32403):

1. Read the text carefully before answering
2. Underline key words in questions
3. Look for evidence in the text
4. Consider the author's purpose
5. Check your answers make sense in context

For Writing (US32405):

1. Plan before writing
 2. Use paragraphs appropriately
 3. Vary sentence length and structure
 4. Check grammar and spelling
 5. Re-read and edit your work
 6. Ensure writing matches the purpose and audience
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Common Student Mistakes

Reading:

- Not reading the whole text before answering
- Missing implied/inferred information
- Not using evidence from the text
- Misunderstanding technical vocabulary

Writing:

- No clear structure or paragraphing
 - Grammar and spelling errors
 - Not matching purpose and audience
 - Writing too much or too little
 - Not proofreading
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NZ Curriculum Alignment

The Literacy co-requisite aligns with approximately Level 4/5 of the NZ Curriculum. Students should:

- Have full control over Level 4 literacy skills
 - Be beginning to work at Level 5
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Assessment Information

CAA Format:

- Digital-first (completed on computer)
- Minimum 60 minutes (no maximum in single session)
- Multiple attempts allowed
- Available from Year 9 onwards

Resources:

- NZQA past papers and exemplars
 - Assessment specifications on NCEA Education website
 - Pathways Awarua online resources
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References

- NZQA Literacy Standards: nzqa.govt.nz/ncea/subjects/litnum/
- NCEA Education: ncea.education.govt.nz/literacy-and-numeracy
- Literacy Assessment Information: ncea.education.govt.nz/literacy-and-numeracy-assessment-information